BEST PERFORMING BIG STATES EDUCATION

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 200	RANK 2021
1	HIMACHAL PRADESH	153.7	1
2	KERALA	135.9	2
3	UTTARAKHAND	134.7	3
4	TAMIL NADU	124.6	5
5	KARNATAKA	115.1	7
6	MAHARASHTRA	113.8	6
7	PUNJAB	112.6	4
8	HARYANA	97.5	9
9	CHHATTISGARH	88.2	10
10	ASSAM	87.8	8
11	ODISHA	86.2	14
12	GUJARAT	85.8	11
13	ANDHRA PRADESH	80.1	12
14	RAJASTHAN	75.7	17
15	WEST BENGAL	73.8	15
16	TELANGANA	73.7	13
17	MADHYA PRADESH	67.5	16
18	UTTAR PRADESH	60.5	18
19	JHARKHAND	47.9	19
20	BIHAR	39.0	20

BEST PERFORMING SMALL STATES EDUCATION

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 200	RANK 2021
1	GOA	164.0	1
2	MIZORAM	146.7	3
3	PUDUCHERRY	146.2	2
4	SIKKIM	127.5	4
5	MANIPUR	124.1	6
6	NAGALAND	117.0	5
7	MEGHALAYA	113.6	7
8	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	113.4	10
9	DELHI	107.8	9
10	TRIPURA	104.1	8

Parameters: Total expenditure of education department on population (10-14 years), literacy rate (%), ratio of girls to boys enrolled in primary and middle school (%), pupil teacher ratio-all institutions, dropout rate in primary+ middle education, number of colleges/ population in the age group 15-19 years, number of schools/ population in the age group 10-14 years, number of institutes of national importance, number of central universities and national law universities, number of higher educational institutions/ population

video conferencing facility, though internet connectivity remains an issue in the hill state. The biggest challenge for new CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu will be to cut down on the dropout rate at the secondary level, which shoots up to 7.6 per cent from just two per cent at the primary level.

Best Performing Small State: Goa

Goa's high literacy rate of 88.7 per cent can be attributed to its extensive education infrastructure—about 125 schools for a million children in the 10-14 age bracket, and 60 colleges for 100,000 youngsters in the 15-19 bracket. The adjusted net enrolment ratio for Classes 1-10 is 90.5 per cent, much higher than the national average (75.8 per cent). The dropout rate at the secondary level is also among the lowest in India at 5.6 per cent.

AN EXTENSIVE EDUCATION INFRA PUTS GOA AND MEGHALAYA ATOP THE SMALL STATE RANKINGS

Most Improved Big State: Rajasthan

Rajasthan has traditionally struggled with low literacy and school enrolment rates. Thus, the lockdown posed a big challenge in containing the dropout rates. "We have started a bridge course to fill the gap in learning, and have backed it up with online examinations," says CM Ashok Gehlot. The department has also recruited 45,000 teachers in two years.

Most Improved Small State: Meghalaya

Meghalaya is spending over Rs 2,500 crore—or just over 15 per cent of its total budget—on education. This trend has been consistent during CM Conrad K. Sangma's tenure. "We are extremely focused on education, which is one of the most challenging sectors," he says. The NITI Aayog has given the northeastern state the second rank in the country in terms of education infrastructure. ■

–Anilesh S. Mahajan, Rohit Parihar and Kaushik Deka